

CanExport Annotated Application

Company Information/Account Profile

Legal name*

Operating name

Date of Incorporation: dd-mm-yyyy*

Describe your products or services* **character limit: 2000**

Suggested layout and length:

Paragraph 1: (~700 characters)

- *Mission statement: "[Company name] is an X whose goal is Y."*
- *Statement of what work, product, or service is provided at a macro level (~200 characters)*
- *Who do they work with generally? Who is their central client base? What types of projects? (~300 characters)*

Paragraph 2: (~650 characters)

- *What do they specialize in? A more detailed description of their product and how clients utilize it for success. (~300 characters)*
- *Description of sales packages, if any, prices of the product/service, how often it is used, what is prioritized in sales and any additional features (~200 characters)*
- *Discussion of how product/service fills a hole in the market. (~150 characters)*

Paragraph 3: (~400 characters)

- *Where is the company headquartered, and where was it founded? In which geographic markets does it currently sell?*
- *Discussion of the makeup of the company (number of employees, where they are based) and what drives internal success.*
- *Any awards that the company has won in recent years.*

Include:

- How long have they been in business?
- What is their mission statement?
- Have they won any awards?
- What do they sell?
- Where do they sell or Who do they sell to (i.e. B2(B)usiness), B2G(overnment), B2C(onsumer), or B2E(nterprise)?
- Who are their distributors/resell partners?
- What are their core offerings?
 - Products: How frequently would customers buy their products?

- Services: What is their contract length (i.e. 6 months)
- What type of packages do they sell?
- Do they customize their offerings by client or are they standardized?

Pick the sector(s) from the following in which your company is mainly active*

Aerospace	Infrastructure
Agriculture & Agri-Food	Life Sciences
Automotive	Manufacturing & Materials
Chemicals	Mining
Consumer Products	Ocean Technology
Cultural Industries	Oil and Gas
Defense and Security	Professional Services
Education	Sustainable Technologies
Financial Services	Tourism
Forestry and Wood Products	Transportation
Industrial Machinery	Wine, Beer & Spirits
Information and Communication Technology	

Fiscal Year End Month

Website

Financial Information

- CRA Business Number*
- Annual Revenue*
- Last Fiscal Year International Revenue*
- Second-to-last fiscal year International Revenue*
- Number of Employees*
- Number of Employees International Business*
- Year Registered*
- Primary Address*

Statistics

- Is your company woman-owned, operated or controlled?*

Yes/No

- Is your company indigenous-owned, operated or controlled?*

Yes/No

- Is your company youth-owned, operated or controlled?*

Yes/No

- *Visible minority-owned, operated or controlled?*

Yes/No

- *LGBTQ2+-owned, operated or controlled?*

Yes/No

- *How did you hear about CanExport SMEs?*

Granted Consulting

TCS History

Has the TCS assisted you in preparing for international markets or will they be supporting you in implementing your export strategy?

Yes/No

If Yes, please specify

- Include name of the TCS
- Briefly describe how they have supported the company
- Flag this section for the GSC to answer AFTER the client has spoken/had email communication with the TCS

Have you previously or are you currently participating in the TCS Canadian Technology Accelerator (CTA) initiative?

Yes/No

If Yes, please specify

Were you referred to the CanExport SMEs program by the National Research Council of Canada's Industrial Research Assistance Program (NRC-IRAP)?

Yes/No

If Yes, please specify

If other Government Agencies: Briefly describe your experience working with these other government agencies in Canada

Has your company worked with other government agencies in Canada (municipal, provincial, territorial, or federal) other than Global Affairs Canada?

Yes/No

If Yes, please specify

Have you previously been approved for a CanExport SMEs project(s)?

Yes/No

Associated Organizations

List all organizations in your corporate group (parent, sister or subsidiary organization)

If applicable, include the following:

- Name:

- Address:
- Number of employees:
- Year registered:
- Revenue:

Project Information

Project Title

Project Start Date (YYYY-MM-DD)

Project Completion Date (YYYY-MM-DD)

Project Contacts

Legal Signing Authority (LSA)

Person responsible for claiming

Project Manager

Project Details

The project title and the summary should not contain any confidential business information. The Government of Canada has implemented a series of measures to strengthen public sector management by enhancing transparency and oversight of public resources in the federal government. The CanExport SMEs program must be able to fully account for the use of public funds. To that end, the National Research Council of Canada, on behalf of the CanExport SMEs program, is required to publicly disclose all financial contributions and grants through the [Government of Canada's Open Government portal](#). Published information may include, but is not limited to company name, project title, project summary and value of contribution or grant.

Project Summary **character limit: 4000**

Suggested layout and length:

Paragraph 1: (~1200 characters)

- *Reiterate of who the company is, their mission statement, and what product/service they bring to market.*

- *When was the company founded, and where are they based? Have they been selling the same product/service since inception? How have they diversified or adapted over time?*
- *What is their dedication to improvement? How are they trying to help their clients and move the industry forward?*
- *Discuss the advantages of their experience as a company if they have been in business for a long time, or if they are new, what edge they bring to the market. What is the value added of both the product/service and of the company who sells it?*
- *Discussion of how they are continuing to improve themselves and make their product/service better or more efficient.*
- *Note any recent awards received.*

Paragraph 2: (~1300 characters)

- *Discussion of reputation in the industry to this point, their current position and level of stability in the Canadian market.*
- *How has the company driven success thus far in Canada? What are the market and industry factors that have catalyzed this success? Have there been any challenges or changes in the market that they have had to overcome to secure their position?*
- *How is the company primed to expand into a new market? What are the key factors that are helping them to grow? What combination of market factors and company innovation? Do they have any information on a new market that gives them a competitive advantage?*
- *Market entrance statement: "These factors have primed [company name] for a comprehensive expansion market entrance to [target market]. In this CanExport project, [company name] will aim to grow our business in this international market by [basic statement of project activities]."*

Paragraph 3: (~800-1000 characters)

- *"The project presented in this application is scheduled to take place from [DATE] to [DATE]. During this time period, we aim to X, X, and X." (generate high-potential leads, gain key knowledge of the competitive landscape of the market, and ultimately, generate sales in the target region.)*
- *Discussion of plans to advance the reputation of the business in the target market and how knowledge gained will increase success in the area.*
- *Briefly discuss the activities planned to meet the project goals, what they include and how they will help to establish business in the target market.*

Paragraph 4: (~500 characters)

- *"This project is aligned with the international trade goals set forth by Global Affairs Canada insofar as it seeks to X."*
- *How will the project advance and strengthen the position of Canada's industry on the international stage?*

- *How will the project work to grow awareness or knowledge of the industry in an international context?*
 - *Any environmental benefits? UN Sustainable Development Goals?*
- Brief company description/introduction (how long they have been in business)
 - Narrative of recent developments in the company's business (e.g. any changes to the business development strategy due to economic conditions or trends switch to online sales, etc.)
 - New/current business development strategy
 - Objective of the project and how it relates to strategy
 - Target markets and target consumers/clients
 - Narrative of activities to achieve that objective
 - Why now?
 - For second+ time applicants, be sure to describe their previous project(s)

Capacity

*Briefly describe your company's capacity in terms of human (internal and external), financial and material resources that will support the proposed activities of this project. **character limit: 4000***

What resources are available? Address human (internal & external), financial, materials

- What is the company's capacity? -- more for product companies in terms of manufacturing capacity
- Do they have a slew of contractors working for them?
- Did they just get a round of funding from investors and have started to grow their team?
- New manufacturing source? New manufacturing partners?

Suggested layout and length:

Paragraph 1: Overview (~500-600 characters)

- *Discuss how the company has grown since its inception and what resources it has that will allow it to continue to grow in an international market.*
- *Provide revenue numbers for the previous 12 months in CAD, calculating revenue growth percentage from year previous to that. Mention whether the majority of revenue comes from international or domestic sales.*
- *By how many employees has the company grown year-over-year, and how many will be dedicated to this project and international business growth overall?*
- *Discuss the company's ability to invest in innovation and product improvement as a way to drive competitive edge and future-proof the brand.*
- *Summarize, mentioning how well the company is positioned to execute the market entrance to the target region.*

Paragraph 2: Financial Resources (~500 characters)

- *Discuss financial resources (or they can also be embedded in one of the other paragraphs above). There is a 50% matching contribution required by the program so the company usually uses retained earnings, loans, investor*

investments, or company savings to pay for the portion of their contribution. If not mentioned in the recording, assume retained earnings.

Paragraph 3: Human Resources (~500-1000 characters)

- *Example: "In this project, we will utilize both internal team members and external contributors. We recognize that payment of staff wages is ineligible under the CanExport program. Likewise, we also recognize the need for all vendors and consultants to be at arms length from the company. For the payment of external consultants, we are prepared to fulfill our 50% matching contribution required by the program."*
- *Summarize the Internal Contributors (employees) linked to the project. Offer a description of the structure of the company, which levels will be participating in the project and how each role will contribute to the project overall*
- *Summarize the External Contributors (vendors) linked to the project. Offer a description of the types of companies that you will be working with (independent consultants etc.) where they are all based, and what sort of activities you will work with them on. Also mention how external contributors will be overseen by internal contributors.*
- *Mention that the project leader will regularly review the course of the project, ensuring that each activity is executed according to the proposed timeline and all awarded funds are being used as efficiently as possible.*
- *For companies that offer services similar to the consultants in the project (i.e. digital marketing firm hiring an SEO consultant), be sure to mention that they lack these skills and therefore require the expertise of an external party*
- *Ex: We selected project activities that we do not have expertise to manage in-house to better the return on investment, and kept project relevant design work internal to reduce the expense of external vendors*

Paragraph 4: Material Resources (~500-1000 characters)

- *Provide a description of current material wealth, capacity and assets of the company that be leveraged or relied on in this project. These can include but are not limited to*
 - *Physical assets such as office space, brick and mortar locations, distribution centres, or any equipment that the company uses to move or store product that will be involved in distribution to the new target market.*
 - *Technological infrastructure including any proprietary software, bespoke platforms or digital tools used by the company, or further IT systems either built by or built for the applicant.*
 - *Supply chain capabilities, referring to any established supplier relationships in the target market or elsewhere adjacent. This can also include a further description of the distribution channels set up by the applicant that will be leveraged in the project.*

- *Market research assets and knowledge, including any market studies completed by external consultants in preparation for the data, pain points/gaps in the market, or profiles of competitors.*
- *Intellectual property assets including trademarks, patents, etc.*

IP Strategy

Do you have an IP strategy for doing business abroad?

Yes/No ← *should be yes, even if they don't have a solid strategy*

Did you consult with an IP consultant?

Yes/No

Please describe your IP strategy (Max. 2,000 characters)

Breakdown:

- *Make mention that company has a well prepared IP protection strategy in place to succeed in the target market. This can be developed specifically in preparation or the project and in combination with existing IP protection measures in place.*
- *List existing IP protection measures: trademarks, patents, certificates, etc. Any other written policies and procedures in place to protect IP assets?*
- *Is there an existing approach for IP protection in the international market?*
- *Discuss the potential IP risks of entering the target market. What needs to be overcome in order to have full security? How is the company currently exposed?*
- *Discuss any necessary IP activities that will be undertaken as part of this project to ensure security in the target market. Mention the development of this strategy in conjunction with a consultant or internal team members dedicated to IP.*
- *What does IP protection success look like by the end of this project? What will need to be undertaken beyond this project to continue to develop business safely and securely?*
 - *Describe their IP strategy*
 - *Have they worked with consultants before? For what?*
 - *What type of IP do they have already? (trademarks, patents, certificates, etc)*
 - *What type of IP do they want? Why?*

Business Case

*Explain your business case by clearly outlining the activities you plan to undertake and how it relates to your company's international business development objectives. Demonstrate how your company plans to undertake and complete the project and how your proposed activities will help you succeed in your chosen target market(s). Explanations provided should be detailed, so as to justify the size and complexity of your project. **character limit: 4000***

This is the core section of the entire writeup

Suggested layout and length:

Paragraph 1: (~1000 characters)

- *What experience does the company have in international market expansion? What level of establishment?*
- *Have they conducted a CanExport before?*
 - *If yes, how does their previous project prime them for market entrance in this one? What have they learned? Why are they entering a new market from the last or why are they returning to the same?*
 - *If not, what other international experience do they have that sets them up for international expansion?*
- *Why will they be successful in the target market?*

Paragraph 2: (~700 characters)

- *Discuss how current growth and earnings primes the company for market expansion.*
- *Any initial successes in the target market that lead them to believe they can have further success?*
- *Discuss the rationale for entering the target market? How is this project advancing the company's "international development strategy" and how will it help them on their "growth trajectory"*
- *What is to be gained by going after specific areas in the target market?*

Paragraph 3: (~300 characters)

- *Discuss the overall objectives in the project. (establish connections, cultivate leads, make sales)*
- *"Through this project, company employees will engage in region-specific activities in pursuit of these goals. Each activity that we outline below is incremental and strategic in scope, serving the overarching aims of our international development strategy."*

Following Paragraphs

- *Give a brief description of the activities undertaken in the project, broken down by each CanExport category.*
- *When will the activity take place? Where will it take place?*
- *How will it be carried out? Using an external vendor?*
- *What is the timeline of the activity?*
- *Refer to other activities if possible to show how each builds on the others.*

Final Paragraph

- *End with a sentence introducing the expected benefits and outcomes of the project if the above activities are successful and list them below in bullet point form*
- *It's good to mention the benefits to Canada from that section, but since there is dedicated space for that, this is a good opportunity to mention other benefits such as:*

- Increased online following
- Stimulating the economy
- Increased website traffic from the target market
- Business-specific outcomes such as enrolment or client retention
- Include: date, timeline, relevance to project, and specifics for each goal
- Any new sales or revenue?

Does this project include participation in a trade mission organized by Global Affairs Canada for groups under-represented in international trade (for example, women, youth, LGBTQ2 or Indigenous)?

Yes/No

Internal Contributors

*Briefly describe key partners or contributors for this project, if applicable, as well as the financial and human resources available to you. **character limit: 4000***

Suggested layout and length:

Paragraph 2 (~400 characters)

- Example: "In this project, we will utilize both internal team members and external contributors. We recognize that payment of staff wages is ineligible under the CanExport program. Likewise, we also recognize the need for all vendors and consultants to be at arms length from the company. For the payment of external consultants, we are prepared to fulfill our 50% matching contribution required by the program."

Internal Contributors

For each internal contributor

- FIRST and LAST NAME, POSITION, LINKEDIN Profile Link. [Name] is in position [X] at [Company name] and has been with the company since [Year]. In this role, [name] focuses on... (outline the role undertaken by the contributor at a macro level). On a day to day basis, [name] is responsible for... (outline the day to day activities of the employee). To [company name], [employee name] brings [x] years of experience, wherein they developed skills [x], [x], and [x]. In this project, [name] will be responsible for [outline the activities that will be overseen over by the employee] and, as such, will lead us toward success in achieving the qualitative and quantitative goals of this project.

For one of the internal contributors:

- Name them as the project lead for the CanExport and main point of contact for the program (these can be two different people. Discuss the role of the project leader as
 - Overseeing all activities in the target market and ensuring that the execution of each is in line with the overall goals of the project and the company's international development strategy.

- *Mention that the project leader will regularly review the course of the project, ensuring that each activity is executed according to the proposed timeline and all awarded funds are being used as efficiently as possible.*

External Contributors

For each external contributors that are vendors

- *“[Name of vendor]: [Name of vendor] is a [description of the company and the product/service that is offered]. In this project, we will be working with [name of vendor] to [description of planned activity with vendor]. We have decided to work with [name of vendor] for this activity based on the extent of their experience working with similar clients and given that we have worked with them before on similar market entrance projects.”*

Internal Contributors

- *Although the program will not provide salary expenses for staff working on this project, it is important to mention the portion of salaries and what this could equate to indicate the an adjudicator that the company is actually investing MORE into this project than their required 25% cash contribution = HUMAN RESOURCES.*
- *Mention the key people involved in the project, particularly who will be managing it*
 - *Experience in the industry, relative work, role in the company*
 - *How their experience will help push this project forward*
 - *Existing connections in the target market*

Existing network in the industry as potential partners/resources

External Contributors

- *These are the consultants who will be executing the activities in the project, and any other contributors like investors and advisors who will help the company succeed with the project*
- *For the consultants, what is their role (i.e. lead generation, marketing, etc.)*
- *If there isn't a named vendor yet, write about what type of vendor would be a good fit for this project and what qualifications (i.e. The graphic designer we will identify closer to the start of this project should be competent in Adobe Illustrator, Web Graphics, and Web Design using Wordpress)*
 - *This can also be added to the budget section if word count is limiting*
- *If the client's vendors tend to be Canadian, make mention of this as well, that the Company will make an effort to provide project activity work to Canadian partners/companies.*
- *Make sure contractors are NOT listed anywhere on the company's LinkedIn or website - the program will not reimburse salary expenses for contractors who may seem to be internal staff and will consider this a breach of trust.*

For EACH activity mentioned in the business case, there should be a bullet point with a couple sentences about who will be executing the activity.

Exporting History

Region	Country	Sub-Region

Target Markets

CanExport SME supports business development into new markets. Your project may target a maximum of five (5) new markets (countries or sub-national markets in the case of Brazil, China, India and the United States).

Region	Country	Sub-Region	Export Sales During the Past Fiscal Year

Market Study

Explain how, in your view, there is strong market potential, how your efforts are part of a coherent international business development strategy. Describe any opportunities, identify any local partner/client leads and outline the challenges your company may face.

MUST INCLUDE FOR EACH TARGET MARKET

[Target Market 1: Market Potential, Opportunities, Challenges/Risks]*character limit: 4000*

Suggested layout and length

Paragraph 1 (~600-800 characters)

- Open by discussing the primary rationale for entering the target market(s).
- Mention that based on success in Canada and other international markets, the business is now primed to expand. Successes to this point have allowed the business the capacity to identify new international markets (either close or far) with high degrees of potential that can be tapped into and drive success for new business development.

- *Mention any specific sites within the target market(s) that have present particular potential for business growth. Any regions or cities?*
- *What trade agreements did Canada sign with this target market that supports Canada's Export Diversification Strategy*
- *Discuss the current state of the industry that the business is in? What are the specifics with regard to the market, and how do they help to present new high potential growth for the business entering?*
- *Describe what the long term outlook is for success in the target market? If there is achieved growth in this project, how will the company continue to leverage new potential either in the target market or beyond?*

"Below we identify and outline multiple opportunities that we perceive are specific to our market expansion to [target market]. We also outline some challenges that we perceive facing once we enter the region, but we provide strategies to mitigate them"

Paragraph 3: Opportunities and Risks

- *List three opportunities for each target region. Approximately 500 characters. Consider:*
 - *Untapped customer segments (Access to new demographics with unmet needs)*
 - *First-mover advantage (Establishing market presence before competitors)*
 - *Product diversification (Adapting offerings for local preferences)*
 - *Economies of scale (Spreading fixed costs across larger sales volumes)*
 - *Resource access (Utilizing local talent, materials, or technology)*
 - *Business cycle diversification (Balancing regional economic fluctuations)*
 - *Knowledge acquisition (Learning new practices, technologies, or approaches)*
 - *Strategic partnerships (Forming alliances with local companies)*
 - *Supply chain optimization (Creating more efficient distribution networks)*
 - *Brand development (Building global recognition and reputation)*
- *List three risks for each target region, with mitigation strategies. Approximately 500 characters. Consider:*
 - *Cultural misalignment (Misunderstanding local customs, values, and preferences)*
 - *Regulatory complexities (Navigating unfamiliar laws, compliance, and bureaucracy)*
 - *Currency volatility (Exposure to exchange rate fluctuations)*
 - *Political instability (Changes in government, policies, or social unrest)*
 - *Economic uncertainty (Market downturn, inflation, or other macroeconomic challenges)*
 - *Intellectual property threats (Weak IP protection or enforcement)*
 - *Operational challenges (Managing remote operations and maintaining quality)*

- *Market education costs (Investment required to build awareness and adoption)*
- *Competitive response (Reaction from established local players)*
- *Reputational risks (Brand damage from cultural missteps or local controversies)*

KEY!! Don't include challenges/risks if you don't have a mitigation plan, you can say that the company is working with experts to ensure risks are minimized but don't say...here's a big problem and we'll have to 'play it by ear'

Paragraph 4: Target Client Profile (~1000 characters)

- *"Our market entrance strategy involves a deliberate approach to foster new relationships and strengthen existing ones in the target market." OR, if B2C: Our market entrance strategy involves a deliberate approach to build a solid consumer base on which to sink our roots into the region, expand and improve our reputation among consumers, and, ultimately, grow our business in the target market."*
- *Provide a basic description of the target-client base and profile for the target market.*
- *List any identified target leads that the company will go after in the target market. Group leads by state within each target market and list the city that they are based in if possible*
 - *Ex: California*
 - *Pacific Clinics (San Jose)*
- *IF B2C: Describe how gaining key information about potential clients in the target market will present the company with a competitive advantage and a better understanding of the consumer details in the target market to help hone in on clientele.*
- *Provide a detailed consumer profile for each target market, or, if there is only one target market provide a few. A target consumer profile should identify:*
 - *Demographics (gender, income level, education, occupation, location, and family status)*
 - *Pain points (Specific problems, challenges, or needs your product/service can solve)*
 - *Buying behaviour (How they make purchasing decisions, preferred purchase channels, price sensitivity, and purchasing frequency)*
 - *Market size and growth (Addressable market size, growth trends, and competitive landscape)*
 - *Communication preferences (Preferred channels, messaging style, and content types that resonate)*

[Target Market 2: Market Potential, Opportunities, Challenges/Risks] *character limit: 4000*

- *If more than 1 target market, the subsequent paragraphs on market potential in the additional markets can have a more narrow focus (first market potential paragraph can discuss global market potential)*

Competitors

Explain how your company differentiates itself from the competition, including your company's competitive advantage and value proposition **character limit: 4000**

MUST INCLUDE FOR EACH TARGET MARKET

[Target Market 1: Competition] **character limit: 4000**

Suggested layout and length: 3 sections

Paragraph 1 (~1000 characters)

- *Open with information about the position of this business's particular market within the more significant international sector. For example, "the global hottub market is the predominant industry in the hydrotherapy sector internationally." Or: "Online elearning platforms and programs are quickly becoming a major part of the broader education industry, particularly in the United States."*
- *If possible, provide as detailed information as possible on market size and growth. What is the value in USD? What is the compound annual growth rate? If possible also provide financials and projections for the target region. For example, how big is the market in the United States vs internationally*
- *Describe the growth factors of the market, how it has developed in the past half decade, and what demand or innovation is moving it forward.*
- *Give a brief discussion of the competitive landscape of the market in the target region. Example: "The competitive landscape is dominated by legacy firms but is now experiencing heavy growth of startups who bring to market an innovated and refined product."*

Paragraph 2 (~250 characters)

- *"Below, we outline three businesses that we have identified as competition for our business endeavours in [target market], we then offer a full analysis of the competitive landscape and argue the strength of our position."*

Following Paragraphs: Competitors

- *Regardless of the amount of target markets, always include at least 3 and up to 5 top competitors (applicant should be able to provide information on key competitors in the region, but this may require some research by writers)*
- *For each competitor consider*
 - *What the company sells, how long they have been in business (legacy vs startup) and their size (how many employees?)*
 - *Growth trajectory: are they continuing to grow and accrue market share, or have they topped out? What is their geographic distribution, do they have their hands in all parts of the market?*
 - *What is their mission statement? What demand are they trying to fill? What is their target client profile?*

- Pricing strategies. Is their product quality a more luxury or affordable option?
- Are they doing and innovation or R&D?
- What is the customer experience like? Normally longtime customers or newcomers?

Following Paragraph: Competitive Analysis

- Open with a discussion of how the competitive landscape of the market has changed in recent years (whether it has grown or declined, whether there are many new businesses driving innovation or if it remains stagnated by the domination of a few key players)
- Talk about how this competitive landscape, whatever it is, presents an opportunity for the applicant business to capitalize on potential growth in the target market (that, for example, some demand is not being fulfilled, or that the competitive landscape is open to new additions)
- Use the points of each competitor to draw out the main themes that are represented in the market (“the competitive landscape is driven by legacy businesses like [named competitor] who have longstanding customers and high retention over years, and by new startups, such as [named competitor], who are driving the innovation of the industry forward and securing clients by offering something new.”)
- Place the applicant business within this competitive landscape. How are they related to the competition, how are they different? How does their entrance to the target market put them in a unique position?
- Outline the value proposition of the applicant business? How do they set themselves apart from competition? Consider
 - Cost structure advantages
 - Intellectual property advantages (What patents, trademarks, copyrights, or trade secrets do you own that create barriers to imitation?)
 - Brand recognition strength
 - Strategic partnerships
 - Distribution channel advantages? Are there any advantages in coming from Canada?
- End with mention of how the competitive advantages will be sustainable over time—that they will be difficult for competitors to copy, substitute, or render obsolete through innovation.

[Target Market 2: Competition] *character limit: 4000*

If applying to multiple markets

Place paragraph 1 in the first market section, along with Paragraph 2 and the first competitor. For each subsequent market, write an introductory paragraph (~1000 characters) of the specifics of the competitive landscape of that market (US West vs US in general), then following paragraphs for each competitor (try to align competitors with target markets). In the final market section, do as advised above and then place the competitive analysis for the entire

project in the final paragraph. If there are multiple markets, you should be able to speak to specific competitive advantages in each. Make mention of how all the markets relate, how they are different, and how they can each be leveraged for success through a strategic approach.

Objectives

- ☐ Gather market information
- ☐ Increase export sales
- ☐ Meet with potential clients
- ☐ Other:
- ☐ Identify potential representative or agents
- ☐ Identify potential partners

Benefits to Canada

Benefit	Details
Increased investments	<i>Example: "With an average salary of \$\$ for our new staff positions, combined with the \$\$ we plan to invest in R&D, this project will generate close to \$\$\$ total reinvestment in the Canadian economy by its end date on DATE."</i>
Increased R&D/Innovation	<i>Example: "With increased revenues as a result of this project, we will be investing heavily in the innovation of [X]. Based on the results of this project, we plan to invest an initial CAD \$\$\$ in this R&D project by the end of this CanExport project deadline."</i>
Increased sales	• <i>Example: "With an average dealership contract valued at \$\$\$, and an expected X new clients as a result of this project, we anticipate increased revenue generation of \$\$\$ by the end of the project timeline."</i>
Job creation	<i>Example: "With the success of this project, our company will be in a strong position to activate the next phase of our international business development strategy. Initiating this process will generate X new positions for the roles of X."</i>

Leads generated	<i>Example: “By the end of the project on DATE, we plan to have generated X new leads as an outcome of [activities X, Y, and Z, and by deepening our business connections in [target market].”</i>
<i>Agreements Signed</i>	<i>Example: “From [description of activities X, Y, and Z, we anticipate signing X new agreements with a close rate of X%.”</i>
Other	

Project Budget

CanExport SME accepts projects valued between \$20,000 to \$100,000. Consultant-related expenses cannot exceed \$66,667, of which the program will pay \$50,000 (75%). Only applicants who are taking part in an international trade mission for under-represented groups organized by Global Affairs Canada may submit a project of less than \$20,000.

Activities must be **divided by Government of Canada fiscal year** (April 1 to March 31 of the following calendar year).

Funding provided for activities in one fiscal year **cannot** be reallocated to another fiscal year. For this reason, we recommend planning your activities carefully and submitting a realistic budget. Your ability to successfully complete the activities as outlined in your application will factor into the evaluation of any future applications.

Applicants are responsible for ensuring that the activities they propose to undertake are eligible. To consult the list of eligible and ineligible expenses, please see the [Applicant's Guide](#).

When entering amounts, do not add any periods, commas, spaces or cents.

Activity Types

- ☐ Category B: PARTICIPATION IN TRADE EVENTS TO MEET KEY CONTACTS FROM TARGET MARKET(S)
- ☐ Category C: MARKETING TOOLS CREATE./ ADAPT./TRANSLATE. FOR TARGET MARKET(S)
- ☐ Category D: INTERPRETATION SERVICES FOR TARGET MARKET(S)
- ☐ Category E: IP PROTECTION/CERTIFICATION/ ADAPT. CONTRACTS FOR TARGET MARKET(S)
- ☐ Category F (CONSULTANT): *BUSINESS, TAX AND LEGAL ADVICE FOR TARGET MARKET(S)
- ☐ Category G (CONSULTANT): *MARKET RESEARCH/ID. KEY CONTACTS/FEASIBILITY. STUDIES/B2B FOR TARGET MARKET(S)

MUST INCLUDE FOR EACH TARGET MARKET

Note: The portal inputs it alphabetically by Activity type, then by Target Market.

- For example, Category C in US-East will go before Category C in US-West, and Category B will go before both of those, etc, no matter what order you put it in

Activity Type	Target Market	Expense Amount for Category by Fiscal Year	Details <i>character limit: 4000</i>
			About the activity • When will it be carried out? • What is its purpose in the project? How is this activity important to the success of the project? I.e. how does it tie to other project activities, or without it Company would be challenged to achieve one of the objectives in Section 6.3 • How long will it take to carry out the activity? Why does it take this long and what is the complexity level? (i.e. need to build momentum, sales processes are long, etc.) • Any relevant milestones to speak of (i.e. once we hit X sales, then we trigger this activity)? • Add expected benefits and leave blanks for clients if necessary. (i.e. \$3,000 a month in social media advertising on LinkedIn through targeted campaigns is expected to generate 3,000 click throughs. Based on our current conversion rate of 5% from organic click throughs, we expect to gain 150 new qualified leads by the end of the project.) About the vendor • Who are they? - Check LinkedIn Profile and Websites • Why did you choose them, usually relevant to their level of experience in providing their type of service and/or success in helping companies expand internationally • Who do they tend to work with (most applicable if they provides services to the same industry as the Company) • Where are they located? • If a company and not an individual, provide an overall summary of the company's successes, maybe awards they've gotten, level of expertise within their own industry (i.e. industry leader in _____)
A			Details to include • Dates of the trip • City they're flying from/to • Purpose of the trip • How many people (max 2) Expenses to include

			• <i>Flights - must be refundable round trip flights</i> • <i>Per diem</i> • <i>Transportation</i> <i>Example</i> <i>"From July 15 - 20th, our VP of Sales, Sean Corscadden, and our CEO, Martin Bates, will travel to London, UK. The intention of this trip will be to meet with target clients in the UK region. These trips are strategically planned in summer to ensure that our spa products will be available in UK showrooms during seasonal spikes in fall and winter.</i> <i>We have determined a list of over 100 potential leads organized into three tiers, corresponding to our first three planned trips to the UK. In this first trip, we will meet with leads from our first tier. Our goal will be to convert one lead with an initial order of 1 case (12 spas), with 3 additional reorders. Based on this goal, our target revenue will be \$384000 for this trip.</i> <i>We have budgeted \$9300 for this activity, which includes roundtrip, refundable flights for two people from Vancouver to London (\$4000), ground travel in London for 6 days (\$500), and per diem for the two travellers for 6 days (\$4800)."</i>
B			<i>Details to include</i> • <i>Dates of the trade show</i> • <i>Number of exhibitors/attendees</i> • <i>Location of the trip</i> • <i>Why this trip specifically</i> • <i>How many people (max 2)</i> <i>Expenses to include</i> • <i>Cost to register/attend trade show</i> • <i>Equipment rental</i> • <i>Shipping expenses</i> <i>Example</i> <i>As Coast Spas dives into the UK market, we are excited to attend the SPATEX conference in Coventry, UK, an international pool and spa exhibition happening February 4 - 6th, 2025. As the largest showcase of its kind in the UK, SPATEX attracts over 1000 local contacts in the spa industry, from spa and pool distributors to commercial consumers such as leisure centres, landscape designers, hospitality, and more. SPATEX's premium position as the first spa exhibition in the calendar year makes it a key strategic target for Coast Spas in the UK market, allowing our team to showcase our new models for 2025 to key distributors and ensure our spas will be in showrooms ready for the popular summer season.</i>

			<i>Throughout the SPATEX event, Coast Spas will host a booth exhibiting our newest spa models for 2025. We have budgeted \$17957 for the exhibition fee, creation, and functioning of our booth which will include 3 spa models.</i> <i>Our goal for the SPATEX conference will be to secure three new accounts, with each account submitting an initial order of 1 container (12 spas), plus 3 reorders each. Based on this goal, our target revenue will be \$1.15 million as a result of our participation at SPATEX.</i>
C			Details to include • <i>How many resources are needed</i> • <i>Outcomes of marketing efforts</i> Expenses to include • <i>Design of landing page</i> • <i>Printing of brochures (for trade show)</i> • <i>Website adaptation</i> • <i>Video (Limited to one for tradeshow or meetings)</i> • <i>Advertising costs related to tradeshow event</i> Example <i>As part of our entrance to the target market, we will need to ensure that our online presence is adept and accurate for converting consumers in the regions that we are invested in. For this reason, as part of this project we will be developing a new landing page specific to the target market, with a focus on obtaining consumers from city [X]. Our aim is that with this new landing page, we will be able to increase the amount of conversions based on the number on the specificity of the site to the interests of the target consumer.</i> <i>For this activity we will be working with [COMPANY NAME], between July 1 and August 31, 2025. [COMPANY NAME] is an independent third-party contractor and digital material production service, with a speciality in developing landing pages for new target markets. In this activity, [COMPANY NAME] will be responsible for the drafting, design, and deployment of the new landing page attached to the target region. This will include tailoring the material to be market-specific and translated to the local language.</i> <i>We have budgeted \$\$\$ for this activity to hire [COMPANY NAME] for the full production of a new landing page. The expected outcome of the work is 1-2 new website pages that</i>

			operate as end points from our digital ads in the target market and captures the specificities of the region.
E			Details to include • See general details in first row • Contract adaption for new target market Expenses to include • IP protection application - not the law firms fees • Cost of contract adjustments
F			Details to include • See general details in first row Expenses to include • Business advice relevant (but not execution or implementation) • Legal expenses • Tax advice <i>Example</i> <i>"To support our expansion efforts in the US West, we will be teaming up with the Vancouver-based law firm Fasken Law. Fasken will be relied on to provide engagement contracts for potential clients in the US West throughout the project timeline. Our team will be working with them on an as-needed basis to draft these contracts so that they are appropriate for the specifics of each client as well as each project we are undertaking.</i> <i>We have chosen to work with Fasken for this expansion project based on our previous successes with them. We believe that by teaming up with their dedicated group, we are putting ourselves in ever safer hands in our entrance to the US West. Insofar as this will be our first time entering an international market, Fasken's contract drafting and legal consulting services will lay the groundwork for our future legal navigation in this area and set our team up for success down the road.</i> <i>We have budgeted \$10,000 to work with Fasken on an as-needed basis during this project between May 15 and December 31, 2024. They will be required to draft all our contracts for new business agreements in the target region."</i>
G			Details to include • See general details in first row Expenses to include • Lead list costs

			• <i>Subscription costs for market research</i> <i>Example</i> <i>"Without proper preparation and market research, it is unlikely that we will be able to advance an expansion that gains any traction in a foreign market. For this reason, we have decided to hire an external consultant to conduct market research for us throughout the project.</i> <i>Bryce R. Margetts is the Senior VP Western Canada for the real estate development consultant Canderel. Canderel is based in Canada and has been in operation since 1975. Today, the company provides a full suite of services that help business map out their real estate development projects from beginning to end, with a focus on sustainable and environmentally friendly developments. In this project, Bryce will be working with our group in a consulting capacity to provide market research and analysis of the landscape of the US West region. In his work, Bryce will identify potential gaps in the real estate development market that we can cater to by offering cutting-edge metalworking products. Bryce will also help our team to outline our ideal target client in the US West and build our business development strategy around this figure.</i> <i>We have budgeted \$10,000 to work with Bryce on this project from May 15 to December 31, 2024. During this time, our team will have regular meetings with Bryce to discuss new learnings in the real estate development market and his research on the development on demand for metal products among the top developers in the region. Bryce will be expected to provide comprehensive research reports throughout our work timeline."</i>
<i>H</i>			<i>Details to include</i> • <i>See general details in first row</i> <i>Expenses to include</i> • <i>Specific type of IP</i> • <i>Why they need the specific IP</i>

Rubric

Applications will be assessed based on the following 7 criteria:

A. Pursuing new or expanded initiatives ("incrementality")

We assess applications based on the following:

- represents new or expanded initiatives aligned with the company's international business development goals and goes beyond the company's core activities

Important: Applicants who have had a previous project approved

New applications should clearly explain how the new project builds on or makes changes to the previous project, highlighting any changes in strategy or focus. For example, the application should explain changes or not to the international business development strategy; indicate rationale for repeat markets or activities; and provide any other relevant information that may help in the evaluation of your application relative to the assessment criteria below.

Note that the program will give priority to clients who have not previously received funding through CanExport SMEs.

A. Export business case

In assessing the likelihood of the project to achieve meaningful commercial outcomes, the program will evaluate whether:

- the objectives, activities and expected outcomes of the project are realistic
- the proposed activities and expenses are specific (such, participation in established commercial events with fixed dates) and reasonable

B. Market potential

The program will assess the choice of target markets by reviewing if the applicant has demonstrated in their application that they have considered the commercial potential of their product or service in the target market(s), such as via market research or gathering other information.

C. Exporting readiness and history

We will review the applicant's:

- capacity in terms of human and financial resources to undertake the proposed activities
- previous export history
- past interactions with CanExport, the TCS, and partners of Global Affairs Canada (GAC)
- explanation of how their products or services are commercialized or ready for export

D. The program will:

- consider performance on previous CanExport projects approved for the applicant
- expect the client to claim the majority of the funds awarded

E. Funds previously approved but not used without reasonable explanation may result in refusal of subsequent applications.

Failure to comply with any conditions of a previously funded project will be considered in the evaluation of a new application.

Spotlight on export readiness

An export-ready business is one that has the capacity, resources and management to deliver a marketable product or service on a global scale at a competitive price. For more information, visit the TCS website to help assess your [export readiness](#).

F. Thematic priorities

We give special consideration to:

- The proposed project's alignment with the [Government of Canada's Export Diversification Strategy](#). The program will prioritize applications that most clearly focus on export diversification.
 - Projects whose target markets are covered by bilateral or regional [free trade agreements](#).
 - Applications submitted by businesses owned or led by groups that are traditionally underrepresented in international trade such as women, Indigenous Peoples, Black Canadians, LGBTQ2+, visible minorities and young entrepreneurs.
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- Lead generation needs to be identification only, not speaking to the clients (even though small meetings happen regardless)

Your financial contribution to the overall cost of the project

The amount of your financial contribution must be between \$5,000 and \$25,000, which is equivalent to 50% of the total eligible project budget. No in-kind contributions permitted.